

# Monica Cholico

## Front-End Software Engineer

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Dear Nicole Zhu,

I'm a front-end engineer at The New York Times, and I'm writing to express my interest in the Software Engineer position on the Games CASH squad. I've spent the past five years building interactive web experiences at the Times, and what draws me to this role is the chance to bring those skills to a product that millions of people love — and to grow as an engineer on a team that values continuous improvement and is clearly looking for someone eager to deepen their backend skills over time.

In my current role, I work on the FlexSuite — the template system that powers custom creative experiences across NYT's digital platforms. Much of that work is conversion-oriented by nature: building configurable, high-performing creative units and landing-page-style experiences designed to capture attention and move audiences to act. I've also built and maintained ad-format versions of Crossword, Wordle, and Connections, turning them into reusable templates that ad producers can configure without engineering support. So I understand these products from the inside — how players interact with them and the editorial care behind every detail — and I'm comfortable building the kinds of surfaces and marketing pages this squad iterates on.

My day-to-day work is in JavaScript, HTML, and CSS, building modular, accessible, responsive components with modern frameworks; over the past two years my team has integrated Astro, TypeScript, Svelte, and more recently React into our stack. I also have React experience from a previous role at Brokerage Engine, where I built features across React and GraphQL on the front-end and Ruby on Rails on the back-end. While React hasn't been my primary framework until recently, that's changing: I was entrusted to lead FlexFactory, a new internal CreativeTech tools application built in Next.js and React and preparing to launch, where I'm responsible for shaping its front-end architecture and direction. Between that and my personal projects, I'm actively deepening React — and this role's frontend focus, paired with the chance to grow into Node.js and Go services on AWS, is precisely the trajectory I'm looking for. This kind of metrics-focused engineering is already part of my day-to-day: I monitor and debug our event-tracking instrumentation to keep our numbers aligned with our analytics partners' reporting — recently tracing why a video ad template was logging more starts than impressions and driving the fix. That instrumentation and production-troubleshooting work maps closely to your team's metrics-focused, experiment-driven approach.

I bring a genuine feel for consumer-facing products from outside of work, too. I founded and built Feel Like Dancing, a niche e-commerce business I've run end-to-end for years, which gave me a hands-on feel for building and operating a consumer-facing product. Planeta Mujer ([planeta-mujer.org](https://planeta-mujer.org)) is an interactive data visualization platform I designed and coded from scratch using D3.js, the Canvas API, and scroll-driven navigation, with its own analytics and SEO infrastructure. I've been using AI-assisted tools — Cursor, Claude, and Copilot — to prototype a Slack-to-Jira workflow automation. These projects keep me curious and push me to learn new tools and patterns, which is how I like to work.

What excites me most about this opportunity is the combination of a product I already care about, a team that values learning and continuous improvement, and work that directly shapes how players experience — and subscribe to — the Times. I'd love the chance to contribute to that.

Sincerely,

**Monica Cholico**